

TABLE 2—EXPANSION OF AFFIRMATIVE ACTION IN THE BRAZILIAN UNDERGRADUATE INSTITUTIONS

	Public institutions				Federal institutions only			
	Institutions	Percent total	Percent ethnic	Percent non-ethnic	Institutions	Percent total	Percent ethnic	Percent non-ethnic
2010	75	19.9	7.9	11.4	48	17.7	6.8	10.5
2011	84	22.7	8.2	13.7	56	21.2	7.0	13.6
2012	87	24.5	8.7	15.1	59	23.4	7.7	15.1
2013	123	32.8	17.9	14.2	94	35.2	20.6	14.1
2014	124	39.0	20.8	17.4	94	42.3	24.5	17.2
2015	126	43.5	23.5	19.2	94	47.7	27.7	19.2

Notes: This table shows the gradual adoption of AA by Brazilian public institutions. In 2010, there are 131 public institutions, including both federal and state. Out of these, 126 adopt AA by 2015. Considering the federal institutions only, there are 94 in 2010, all of which adopt AA by 2013, as required by federal law. In this table, an institution is defined as an AA-adopter if it reserves at least 5 percent of its vacancies to quotas. Column *percent total* refers to the total percentage of vacancies reserved to AA quotas. Column *percent ethnic* refers to vacancies reserved to non-White public school and *percent non-ethnic* to vacancies reserved to public school students of every ethnicity. The small difference from the column “Total” to the sum of columns “Ethnic” and “Non-ethnic” is due to the existence of quotas reserved to other groups, such as individuals with disabilities or public school teachers.

Source: Documents of College Admission and Higher Education Census (2010–2015)

centers and institutes.¹⁷ My final sample of incoming students comprises 2,282,078 individuals, distributed in the 2010–2015 period, as specified by Table 3.

Second, I use data from the National Exam of High School (ENEM) Microdata from 2009 to 2014. This dataset contains information on test scores of all students that took the exam each year with their demographic and socioeconomic characteristics. A unique individual identifier (social security number) is used to link information from the ENEM dataset of year $t-1$ with the CES data of incoming students of year t . Both datasets are only available with individual identifiers at the headquarters of the National Institute for Educational Studies and Research (INEP), of the Brazilian Ministry of Education, in Brasilia, where they can be accessed upon approval of research projects.

Table 3 contains descriptive statistics of the main variables used in the analysis of this paper. It shows an overall increase in the participation of public school, public school non-White, and public school low-income individuals in the student body, while the share of out-of-state students remained stable. The dummy variables of whether individuals attended a public high school and their ethnicity come directly from students’ responses in the ENEM questionnaire. When these variables are missing, the information is complemented with the answer contained in the CES dataset.¹⁸ The variable of low income is defined as whether individuals come from

¹⁷These individuals correspond to only 5.7 percent of incoming students in public institutions. They are excluded because the information regarding the adoption of AA in these institutions is missing.

¹⁸By adopting this procedure, I reduce considerably the number of missing values for these two characteristics. I use the ENEM dataset as the primary source for public school status because students answer whether they attended a public high school during *all three years* of upper secondary, a requirement for qualifying to the AA law. In the CES, in contrast, the type of school refers to the institution where students graduated from high school. Furthermore, the variables available at the ENEM microdata have considerably fewer missing values than the variables available at the CES, especially for ethnicity and for years 2010–2012, as shown in Table B.2 in the online Appendix. A more thorough description of the construction of the variables is available in online Appendix A. A careful robustness exercise considering different primary sources of data is available in online Appendix B.